

PACE MVP Executive Summary

Pilot case: FIN1 Butler Lumber Day 1

Problem

FIN1 students often struggle to convert case materials, exhibits, tools, and Excel work into a class-ready point of view. Generic AI chat can make this worse by giving polished answers too early. PACE solves a narrower problem: force preparation evidence, scaffold the hard concepts, and surface where students are stuck before class.

MVP Features

- Canvas-style student flow with five gated stages: tools, tutorial, assignment, reflection, and submit.
- Butler Lumber Day 1 content loaded into the app: tools PDF, Excel template, tutorial checks, and assignment prompts.
- Excel-required questions ask students to complete the model first, then enter an answer and reasoning.
- Student report download captures preparation evidence and pre-class reflection.
- Instructor dashboard shows submissions by hour, average completion time, and most common stuck points.
- Local Excel taskpane helper gives process guidance for selected cells, sources and uses, cash conversion cycle, and modeling workflow.

What Is Working Locally

- Student App: working local Vite app at <http://127.0.0.1:5173/> with gated Butler workflow.
- Instructor View: working local dashboard backed by browser localStorage and demo-data seeding.
- Excel Plugin: working taskpane served at </excel-plugin/taskpane.html> with Office.js hooks and browser fallback.

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- Artifacts: executive summary PDF and Professor Baker feedback email generated in /deliverables.

Pending to Scale

- Replace localStorage with authenticated persistence tied to Canvas roster and assignment IDs.
- Add a professor authoring workflow for cases, tool PDFs, tutorial videos, rubrics, and Excel template mappings.
- Connect AI responses to a guarded retrieval layer over approved FIN1 materials and case-specific rubrics.
- Instrument learning outcomes: completion quality, misconception clusters, class participation, and performance deltas.
- Harden the Excel add-in for production with HTTPS hosting, Microsoft 365 deployment, telemetry, and cell-level rubric checks.
- Run a controlled pilot with Professor Baker to validate whether the flow improves preparation without answer leakage.

Immediate Ask

Use Butler Lumber as a live feedback pilot: review the student flow, identify where the prompts should be stricter or more helpful, and decide which FIN1 case should be the second build-out.